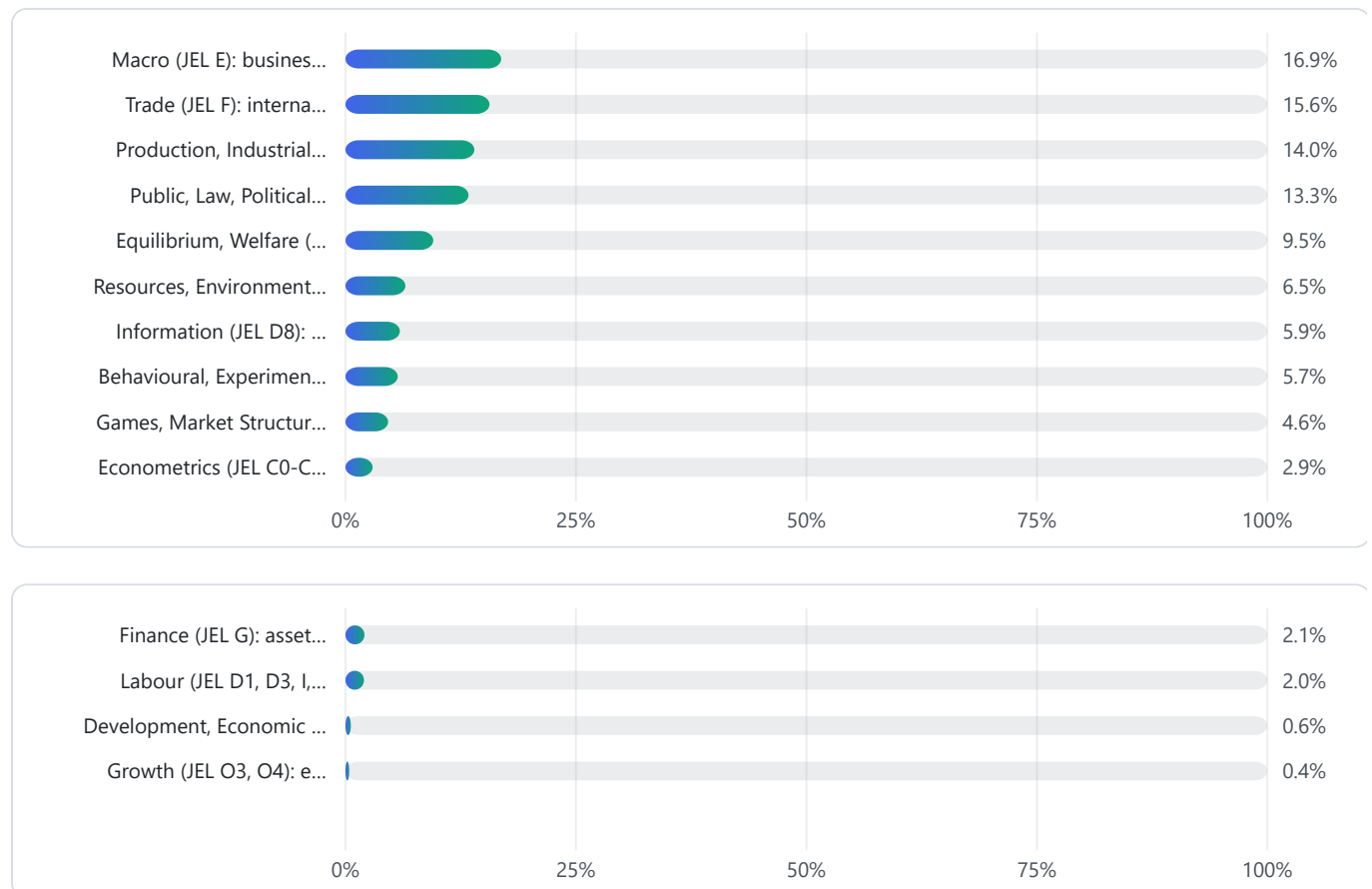




Which field of economics will the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences recognize?

Generated 2026년 10월 10일 오후 1:51

Forecast distribution



Full option labels

1. Macro (JEL E): business cycles, money and monetary policy, consumption and saving, fiscal policy, national accounts
2. Trade (JEL F): international trade, international finance and open-economy macroeconomics, exchange rates
3. Production, Industrial Organization (JEL D2, L, M): theory of the firm, transaction costs and organizations, industrial organization and regulation, business economics
4. Public, Law, Political Economy (JEL D7, H, K, P): public economics and taxation, collective decision making and public choice, law and economics, political economy and economic systems
5. Equilibrium, Welfare (JEL C6, D5, D6): general equilibrium, welfare economics, social choice, mathematical and optimization methods

6. Resources, Environment (JEL Q, R): environmental and climate economics, natural resources and energy, agriculture, urban and regional economics
7. Information (JEL D8): asymmetric information, contract theory, mechanism design, decision making under uncertainty
8. Behavioural, Experimental (JEL C9, D9): behavioural economics, psychological and intertemporal decision making, laboratory and field experiments
9. Games, Market Structure (JEL C7, D4): game theory, bargaining, matching, auctions and market design
10. Econometrics (JEL C0-C5, C8): econometric theory and methods, causal inference, time series, data and estimation methods
11. Finance (JEL G): asset pricing, corporate finance, banking and financial crises, financial markets
12. Labour (JEL D1, D3, I, J): labour markets, household and family economics, income distribution, health and education economics
13. Development, Economic History (JEL N, O1, O2, O5): development economics, poverty, economic history, economywide country studies
14. Growth (JEL O3, O4): economic growth, innovation and technological change, productivity, institutions and growth

TL;DR

Macro leads at 17%, followed by Trade at 16%, Production/Industrial Organization at 14%, and Public/Law/Political Economy at 13% (forecast calculations). These four fields hold 60% of the probability because long gaps in recognition coincide with mature, distinct research programmes (assessment and calculations). The forecast selects one primary-JEL field, not every field represented in the laureates' work (resolution convention).

Context

The announcement is scheduled for October 12, 2026, no earlier than 11:45 CEST, or 09:45 UTC (announcement schedule). I apply the stipulated October 9, 2026 information cutoff. The historical coding, committee profiles, and reported paper findings supplied by the client are accepted premises, not independently reconstructed data (input provenance).

The event is the single field selected by the specified consensus coding of the official motivation. A divided prize uses its overall motivation where available, otherwise the larger contribution share, then announcement order. The distribution is conditional on a valid field assignment and sums to 100%; there is no separate annulment allocation (resolution and calculation audit).

Evidence

The historical backbone covers 1969–2025: 57 annual prizes and 64 separately recognized works. Counts below are share-weighted prize equivalents, not laureates or papers. The classification vintage is October 9, 2026; the recent windows are 2021–2025 and 2016–2025. The following table preserves the full award-year history in the client’s classification. A year marked ½ contributes half a prize; multiple contributions within the same field are combined (complete supplied record and checks).

Baseline rank	Field	All award years, 1969–2025	Total prize shares	Last award / waiting years to 2026	Shares 2021–2025 / 2016–2025
1	Equilibrium, Welfare	1970, 1972, 1973, 1975, 1983, 1988, 1998	7.0	1998 / 28	0 / 0
2	Macro	1974, 1976, 1981, 1984, 1985, 1995, 2004, 2006	8.0	2006 / 20	0 / 0
3	Trade	1977, 1999, 2008	3.0	2008 / 18	0 / 0
4	Public, Law, Political Economy	1986, 2009½	1.5	2009 / 17	0 / 0
5	Production, Industrial Organization	1978, 1982, 1991, 2009½, 2014	4.5	2014 / 12	0 / 0
6	Information	1996, 2001, 2007, 2016	4.0	2016 / 10	0 / 1
7	Behavioural, Experimental	2002, 2017	2.0	2017 / 9	0 / 1
8	Resources, Environment	2018½	0.5	2018 / 8	0 / 0.5
9	Games, Market Structure	1994, 2005, 2012, 2020	4.0	2020 / 6	0 / 1
10	Econometrics	1969, 1980, 1989, 2000, 2003, 2011, 2021½	6.5	2021 / 5	0.5 / 0.5
11	Finance	1990, 1997, 2013, 2022	4.0	2022 / 4	1 / 1
12	Labour	1992, 2010, 2015, 2021½, 2023	4.5	2023 / 3	1.5 / 1.5
13	Development, Economic History	1979, 1993, 2019, 2025½	3.5	2025 / 1	0.5 / 1.5
14	Growth	1971, 1987, 2018½, 2024, 2025½	4.0	2025 / 1	1.5 / 2

At the work-field level, the supplied record contains three adjacent-year repetitions across 56 transitions: Equilibrium in 1972→1973, Macro in 1984→1985, and Growth in 2024→2025 (transition record). That does not establish a fixed rotation policy. The supplied Dolton–Tol findings report an insignificant previous-year-award dummy, and their transition model is an in-sample description rather than validated forecasting performance (reported study). I therefore apply strong rotation as the requested forecasting design, not as a proven committee rule.

My record-only score combines waiting time, recency tiers, and recent concentration in one prior:

$$r_i = \frac{e^{0.040w_i t_i}}{1 + 0.25n_{5i} + 0.05(n_{10i} - n_{5i})}.$$

Here, w_i is the waiting time, and n_{5i} and n_{10i} are the recent share counts. The tier multiplier t_i is 1.35 for fields last awarded in 2015 or earlier, 1.00 for 2016–2020, 0.55 for 2021–2023, and 0.22 for 2024–2025. These are judgmental settings, not coefficients copied from the paper. Subtracting the five-year count from the ten-year count keeps the concentration windows disjoint. Waiting time and tiers remain related features of one designed prior, not independent evidence (model specification).

I normalize these scores, multiply by a mature-work factor, and normalize again. The maturity factors assess research programmes: their importance, accumulated development, distinction from recognized work, and likely primary-code assignment. They do not count coauthors as separate opportunities or treat the paper's historical candidate pools as living, unawarded inventories (assessment rules).

The strongest positive evidence is contribution-specific. The February 25, 2025 recognition of Blanchard, Galí, and Woodford describes a developed monetary-policy framework with substantial central-bank and teaching use. This supports Macro's remaining scientific inventory, rather than merely its long wait (BBVA citation). Empirical IO has similarly direct validation: the February 20, 2018 award to Bresnahan, Pakes, and Porter recognized a coherent programme for measuring competition and market power, including regulatory applications. Its joint nature is a reason to count the programme once, not three times (BBVA citation).

Equilibrium/Welfare requires a different adjustment. Its classical foundations received substantial prior recognition, but the remaining inventory is not empty. Mas-Colell's general-equilibrium work, Thomson's fair-allocation programme, and Roemer–Trannoy's normative equality-of-opportunity literature establish distinguishable reserves (general-equilibrium recognition; fair-allocation publications; December 2016 review). Sonnenschein's death on July 15, 2021, and Guesnerie's death on January 3, 2026, narrow specific packages; they do not

eliminate the field’s remaining programmes (University of Chicago; Collège de France). I use a moderate saturation discount, not a near-total one.

Auxiliary signals receive smaller adjustments. Clarivate’s September 17, 2026 release recognizes Woodford’s monetary-policy work, Athey and Varian’s information-technology economics, and Winter’s organizational research. Clarivate explicitly says these selections are not predictions for a particular Nobel year. I use one small recognition premium for Macro and IO, with digital-economics classification spillovers retained (dated release). Econometrics receives a small additional premium from Manski’s February 25, 2026 recognition, alongside the mature semiparametric programme documented in Newey’s Nemmers citation (Manski citation; Newey citation).

The Academy also lists a 2026 Nobel Symposium on exchange rates and international capital markets. That is a positive field signal for Trade under the F-code mapping, but it is not evidence of a settled prize choice. The listing supplies a topic and organizer, not a programme, participant list, or link to the selection decision (Academy listing).

Committee coverage changes little. The accepted profiles support modest adjustments for evaluation capacity, particularly in Macro, Public, IO, and Resources. They do not reveal preferences, and I do not assign equal votes to regular members, co-opted members, and the secretary. Societal factors reflect the client’s proposed applications—trade, technology, inequality, and the environment—not a measured attention index (committee premises and adjustment ledger).

The complete probability construction follows. M is the maturity multiplier; S is societal relevance; K is committee coverage; W is the additional dated-signal multiplier. Every stage is renormalized. Probabilities are shown at meaningful whole-percent precision, with sub-percent outcomes marked <1%; exact distributions and factors are in the linked audit. Positive multipliers can still produce a lower normalized probability when competitors receive larger adjustments (full calculation ledger).

Field	Record-only	M	After maturity	S	K	W	Final rank	Submitted
Equilibrium, Welfare	19%	0.70	10%	1.00	1.00	1.00	5	10%
Macro	14%	1.55	16%	1.02	1.03	1.05	1	17%
Trade	13%	1.50	15%	1.03	0.99	1.12	2	16%
Public, Law, Political Economy	12%	1.45	14%	1.03	1.02	1.00	4	13%

Field	Record-only	M	After maturity	S	K	W	Final rank	Submitted
Production, Industrial Organization	10%	1.75	13%	1.03	1.02	1.06	3	14%
Information	6%	1.25	6%	1.00	1.01	1.00	7	6%
Behavioural, Experimental	6%	1.25	6%	1.00	1.01	1.00	8	6%
Resources, Environment	6%	1.40	7%	1.03	1.02	1.00	6	6%
Games, Market Structure	5%	1.15	5%	1.00	1.01	1.00	9	5%
Econometrics	3%	1.40	3%	1.00	1.01	1.06	10	3%
Finance	2%	1.20	2%	1.00	1.01	1.00	11	2%
Labour	2%	1.30	2%	1.02	1.02	1.00	12	2%
Development, Economic History	<1%	0.90	<1%	1.00	1.00	1.00	13	<1%
Growth	<1%	0.75	<1%	1.00	1.00	1.00	14	<1%

The field assessments below explain the scientific adjustment and its main counterweight. Historical comparisons refer to the accepted coding above, not a reclassification designed to escape recency penalties (historical contribution record).

Field	Representative remaining contributions and supporting grounds	Main opposing grounds
Macro	New Keynesian stabilization, nominal rigidities, commitment, and monetary-policy design. A coherent, mature framework supports promotion from the record-only second place (contribution citation).	The primary-E clock understates macro recognition through econometrics and banking. Financial-amplification proposals also overlap already recognized crisis work.

Field	Representative remaining contributions and supporting grounds	Main opposing grounds
Trade	Heterogeneous-firm trade, export selection, quantitative trade, and open-economy adjustment. Melitz's programme changes the unit of analysis from representative firms to firm selection and reallocation (foundational working paper).	Some contributions overlap the earlier scale-economy transformation or Growth. Eaton's death narrows one natural quantitative-trade package without removing the programme (Yale memorial).
Production, Industrial Organization	Structural demand and supply, competitive conduct, entry, and market counterfactuals. BLP provides a mature empirical framework distinct from regulation theory; this supports its rise from baseline fifth to final third (BLP).	BLP and broader empirical IO overlap and should not be counted as separate inventories in full. Discrete-choice ancestry and a methods-centered motivation create Econometrics or Labour spillovers.
Public, Law, Political Economy	Implementable optimal taxation and political incentives governing policy choice. Saez's elasticity-based tax design and the Besley–Persson–Tabellini programme provide distinct mature paths (tax framework; political-economy citation).	Institutions-and-prosperity work remains subject to the recent Growth penalty. Taxation also overlaps previously recognized incentive theory; inequality measurement alone belongs elsewhere.
Equilibrium, Welfare	General-equilibrium extensions, incomplete-market allocation, fair division, and normative equality of opportunity. The latter programmes prevent an exhaustion verdict (fair allocation; equality of opportunity).	Classical foundations already received broad recognition. Contributor losses and boundaries with voting, mechanisms, and bargaining reduce the clean remaining inventory. This explains its fall from baseline first to final fifth.
Resources, Environment	Natural capital, biodiversity, sustainable wealth, and resource allocation; urban economics supplies another route under the stipulated mapping. Dasgupta's programme differs from a generic repeat of climate modeling (environmental-economics citation).	The climate award still matters. A motivation framed mainly around intergenerational welfare could resolve outside Q/R.
Information	Economic networks, information acquisition, and decision-making under uncertainty. Jackson's network programme is a mature path beyond classic contracts and mechanisms (network contribution).	Several foundational information programmes have already won. Strategic-network or application-specific wording can shift the primary code to Games, IO, or Finance.
Behavioural, Experimental	Formal social preferences, reciprocity, self-control, and psychologically grounded choice. Rabin's programme demonstrates longstanding theoretical depth, not just current popularity (AEA assessment).	Earlier behavioural and experimental awards covered broad territory. A new motivation must identify a distinct contribution rather than reaffirm the field generally.

Field	Representative remaining contributions and supporting grounds	Main opposing grounds
Games, Market Structure	Learning, reputation, bargaining, and dynamic strategic interaction. Fudenberg’s accumulated contributions provide a mature reserve beyond auction design (AEA assessment).	The field has already received broad game-theory, repeated-game, matching, and auction recognition. Its shorter wait limits promotion.
Econometrics	Partial identification, semiparametric estimation, and inference under weak assumptions. Manski and Newey represent mature programmes distinct from a narrow causal-inference package (Manski; Newey).	Recent methodological recognition imposes a substantial rotation penalty. Methods used in an application do not guarantee a C-code motivation.
Finance	Corporate governance, financing, and limits to arbitrage remain distinguishable from banking-crisis research (Shleifer assessment).	Recent banking recognition and earlier asset-pricing awards weigh against it. Law, contracts, and information can dominate the eventual classification.
Labour	Health insurance, education, and household economics provide reserves beyond wage and gender contributions. Finkelstein’s health-insurance programme establishes a distinct mature path (AEA assessment).	Recent concentration remains decisive under the requested prior. Health-insurance work can also resolve as Information or Public depending on the recognized core.
Development, Economic History	Village insurance, development finance, and long-run development outside the recently recognized innovation narrative remain possible. Townsend illustrates a mature theory-and-measurement programme (foundational contribution).	Immediate recent recognition dominates the rotation assessment. Remaining packages also cross Information, Finance, and Labour boundaries.
Growth	Productivity, misallocation, and aggregate efficiency retain mature contributions beyond creative destruction (Hsieh–Klenow).	Major growth programmes have already been recognized. The residual inventory has classification spillovers, while the consecutive recent awards impose the strongest rotation disadvantage.

What's non-obvious

The option labels are not reliable shortcuts. Voting and social choice coded D71 resolve as Public, despite “social choice” appearing among Equilibrium/Welfare’s illustrative keywords. Network theory coded D85 resolves as Information, not automatically Games. Normative equity coded D63 belongs to Equilibrium/Welfare, while income distribution coded D3 belongs to Labour. The code groups, not familiar field names, drive the outcome (official JEL definitions; stipulated mapping).

The symposium signal also has a narrower meaning than its headline suggests. Exchange rates and international capital markets point directly toward international macroeconomics and finance, which count as Trade here. They do not specifically identify heterogeneous-firm trade as the intended contribution. I raise the field's weight modestly without turning a conference listing into a candidate shortlist or treating it as an independent confirmation of every trade programme (Academy listing).

Uncertainties

The strongest assumption is rotation itself. Removing only the recency tiers, while retaining the other ingredients, raises the combined probability of fields last awarded during 2021–2025 from 8% to 19%. The submitted forecast keeps the strong tiers because that is the requested main design. The low recent-field probabilities are therefore conditional on that design, not evidence of a committee prohibition (structural sensitivity).

Maturity judgments can reorder the leading fields. A 50,000-draw parameter sensitivity exercise gives central 80% ranges of roughly 13–21% for Macro, 12–19% for Trade, 11–17% for IO, 10–17% for Public, and 6–14% for Equilibrium/Welfare. These are scenario ranges, not calibrated confidence intervals; private committee information and model-form error add uncertainty beyond them (sensitivity specification and results).

The missing evidence is a contemporary contribution-level nomination inventory, the committee's actual shortlist, a comprehensive survival audit, and a validated link between symposium topics and same-year awards. Nominee identities remain confidential for 50 years, so public recognition cannot supply the shortlist (Nobel nomination rules). Dated activity supports surviving representation, but does not certify every illustrative researcher's eligibility through the cutoff. Societal attention is unmeasured, and committee expertise is not inferred preference (evidence limits).

Finally, the motivation's wording can move a cross-field contribution between options. I include that risk in the maturity assessments rather than assigning all probability to the researcher's usual field. The six-decimal JSON values preserve the normalized calculation; they do not imply six-decimal certainty about a secret decision (exact probability audit).

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- **The Frontiers of Knowledge Award goes to Timothy Besley, Torsten Persson and Guido Tabellini for transforming political economy into a modern, empirical, interdisciplinary science - Premios Fronteras**
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- **The Frontiers of Knowledge Award goes to Partha Dasgupta for defining the field of environmental economics by incorporating and quantifying the social value of nature - Premios Fronteras**
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Question Details

The 2026 Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel is scheduled to be announced on Monday 12 October 2026, 11:45 CEST at the earliest. The options are the 14 fields of economics of Dolton and Tol (2026), each defined as a group of JEL codes (in brackets) and illustrated by a few keywords. The field of the awarded contribution is read from the official motivation through its JEL code; exactly one option resolves.

Resolution Criteria

Resolves to the field that contains the primary JEL code of the contribution recognized by the official motivation of the 2026 prize (nobelprize.org). The primary code is the level-3 JEL code of the core of the recognized contribution, determined by the same procedure that coded the prizes of 1969-2025: three language models code the official motivation independently, and their consensus (JEL letter, then two-digit field, then code; a two-model majority, otherwise the highest score) is mapped to the fields by the code groups in the option labels. If the prize is divided between contributions in different fields, the overall motivation of the prize is coded when the announcement gives one; otherwise the contribution with the larger share counts; if the shares are equal, the contribution named first in the announcement counts. If the primary code is in no option (JEL A, B, Y, Z or a general code such as Do), the field named by the majority of the contribution's secondary codes counts; if no field can be assigned, the question is annulled.